

NPC Cards – The Heavenly Crucifix

NPC1 – Cardinal Albrecht Voss

ROLE Church Recovery Lead – Congregation for the Doctrine of the Faith

ORGANIZATION 03 – The Church

DISPOSITION 3 – Cordial but guarded

SECRET Voss knows the crucifix's pagan origin. His predecessor in the Congregation discovered it in 1923 and buried the finding. Voss found the file three years ago. He has told no one – not Rome, not his team. If the crucifix is recovered, he must decide: reveal the truth and face a theological crisis, or destroy the crucifix and preserve the Church's narrative. He has not decided. Every action he takes is haunted by this secret.

GOAL Recover the crucifix. Verify its authenticity in private. Then decide. He is not a villain – he is a sincere man trapped between faith and institutional survival.

ARTIFACT CONNECTION Has studied the Martinice file for three years. Knows more about the crucifix than anyone except the Countess and the Covenant. Has never touched it.

STARTING KNOWLEDGE I5, I13

GAINED KNOWLEDGE I11 (03M1), I12 (03M2)

LOCATIONS L1 (after 03M1), L7 (Day 1)

+ / - RESULTS + If agents share CT-1 with Voss, he pauses operations for 24 hours and shares I13 in return. – If agents threaten the Church's reputation or attempt to blackmail Voss, he escalates to 03M2 immediately.

NPC2 – Countess Alžběta Martinice

ROLE Last of the Martinice Line – Keeper of Family Secrets

ORGANIZATION None (civilian)

DISPOSITION 4 – Welcoming, eager to talk

SECRET She knows the shrine site location. She visited it once, in 1937, at age 13, with her grandmother. She has never told anyone – not the communists who seized her property, not the Church, not her own children. She was waiting for someone who would ask the right questions.

GOAL To pass the story to someone who will believe it before she dies. She is 82. She does not expect to see another winter.

ARTIFACT CONNECTION Family guardian for generations. Donated the crucifix under pressure in 1952. Has regretted it every day since.

STARTING KNOWLEDGE I4, I5, I6, I7

GAINED KNOWLEDGE –

LOCATIONS L2 (Brno retirement home)

+ / – RESULTS + She gives the agents her letters and family tree. – If treated poorly, she closes permanently. I4–I7 are only available via HQ fallback (lose 2 shifts).

NPC3 – Klaus Reiner

ROLE Lead Thief – Current Bearer of the Crucifix

ORGANIZATION 01 – The Thieves

DISPOSITION 1 – Hostile, arrogant, manic

SECRET Reiner was not supposed to wear the crucifix. The job was simple: steal it, deliver it, get paid. But he put it on during the escape – just to see. After Vienna, where he let himself be shot three times to confirm it worked, he stopped being a thief and started being something else. He has not removed the crucifix in two weeks. He sleeps in it. He believes he is now beyond consequence. He is wrong.

GOAL Complete the sale, take the money, and disappear. But he is also deeply, compulsively unwilling to remove the crucifix. He will fight to keep it – not for money, but because without it he is mortal again, and he cannot face that.

ARTIFACT CONNECTION Current bearer. Wearing continuously for 14+ days. Full immortality mania (Stage 2). Invincible to physical harm. Corruption: 11 (Reality Distortion stage).

STARTING KNOWLEDGE I1, I8

GAINED KNOWLEDGE I9 (after 01M1)

LOCATIONS L7 (Day 2–1). Earlier: agents must track him through I8–I11.

+ / – RESULTS + If agents convince Reiner he is being set up (Varga plans to betray him – true), he may negotiate. – Any attempt at physical force confirms his invincibility and escalates the scene to violence. He will challenge the agents to kill him. They cannot.

NPC4 – Elena Varga

ROLE Compact Broker – The Middlewoman

ORGANIZATION 02 – Vantablack Compact

DISPOSITION 2 – Professional, transactional

SECRET Varga has already been paid a retainer by the buyer. If the sale falls through, she keeps the money. She is currently engineering a scenario where Reiner is neutralized (preferably killed, though she now knows that's impossible), the crucifix is delivered, and she collects the balance. If Reiner cannot be killed, she will settle for having him arrested or detained. She is the most pragmatically flexible NPC in the case – and the most dangerous, because she has no loyalty to anyone.

GOAL Close the sale. Collect her 15% commission. Disappear. If the sale fails, pivot to selling information about the buyer to the highest bidder.

ARTIFACT CONNECTION Handled it once, with gloves. Has no supernatural interest – sees it purely as inventory.

STARTING KNOWLEDGE I9, I10, I14, I16

GAINED KNOWLEDGE I12 (02M2), I17 (02M3)

LOCATIONS L3 (until 02M1), L7 (Day 2–1)

+ / – RESULTS + Varga will betray Reiner, the buyer, or the Church – whoever offers the best deal. A Manipulate (Diff 3) or a credible bribe gains her cooperation. – If agents threaten her or her operation, she disappears and takes her knowledge with her. I9, I10, I14, I16 become HQ-only.

NPC5 – Father Tomas

ROLE Jesuit Historian – Church Recovery Team

ORGANIZATION 03 – The Church

DISPOSITION 3 – Scholarly, curious, less guarded than Voss

SECRET Tomas has read the Martinice file. He knows the crucifix is pagan. Unlike Voss, he is not conflicted – he is excited. He believes the truth makes the object more significant, not less: proof that God works through unexpected materials. He has been quietly trying to convince Voss to publish the finding. Voss has been refusing.

GOAL Study the crucifix. Publish the truth – that divinity can manifest through meteoric iron as easily as through blessed relics. He sees this as expanding the Church's understanding, not threatening it. He is naive about the institutional consequences.

ARTIFACT CONNECTION Has studied the file extensively. Can identify the crucifix's origin with a Lore check. Carries a 1923 letter from Voss's predecessor describing the shrine site.

STARTING KNOWLEDGE I5, I7, CT-1

GAINED KNOWLEDGE I18 (after visiting L6, if agents take him there)

LOCATIONS L2 (after 03M1, if agents haven't been yet), L6 (if agents bring him), L7 (Day 1)

+ / – RESULTS + Tomas will share CT-1 and I5 with agents who engage him intellectually. He is the easiest path to the shrine site – he has directions. – If agents mock or dismiss his faith, he withdraws. Tomas reports everything to Voss.

NPC6 – Hans (Hansjörg Metzler)

ROLE Swiss Guard – Church Recovery Team (Security)

ORGANIZATION 03 – The Church

DISPOSITION 1 – Silent, watchful, protective of Voss

SECRET Hans is not just a Swiss Guard. Before taking the Vatican oath, he served six years in Swiss military intelligence. He speaks four languages and has killed two men – both in defense of Church personnel during a 1983 artifact incident the Vatican never acknowledged. He is not here for the crucifix. He is here to keep Voss alive, and he will do that at any cost. He is the only person in the case who might be able to physically restrain Reiner – not through violence, but through submission holds and sedation (Brawl 3, Heal 2).

GOAL Protect Voss. Secondary: recover the crucifix for the Church. If these goals conflict, Voss's safety wins.

ARTIFACT CONNECTION None. He regards it as an object, not a relic. His faith is in people, not things.

STARTING KNOWLEDGE I5

GAINED KNOWLEDGE CT-2 (he figured it out independently – he has training in non-lethal restraint)

LOCATIONS L7 (Day 2–1). Earlier: accompanying Voss.

+ / – RESULTS + If agents share CT-2 with Hans, he becomes an ally. At the hunting lodge, he will help restrain Reiner rather than fight the agents. – If agents threaten Voss, Hans engages without warning. Treat as a Medium-threat adversary (Brawl 3, Endure 3, Armor 1).

NPC7 – Margot Lefèvre

ROLE Art Dealer – Warhol's Intermediary

ORGANIZATION 04 – The Buyer (civilian intermediary)

DISPOSITION 2 – Cautious, discreet, name-dropping when it suits

SECRET Margot has been Warhol's "special acquisitions" dealer for six years. She has sourced occult objects before – nothing like this, but she is not naïve. She knows the crucifix is real. She has seen the photographs from Vienna. She is terrified of Reiner and deeply uneasy about what Warhol is buying. She has been taking Valium to sleep. If cornered, she will name Warhol – not out of disloyalty, but because she cannot carry the weight of the secret alone anymore.

GOAL Complete the acquisition. Protect Warhol's anonymity. Go home and never take another commission like this.

ARTIFACT CONNECTION Has seen photographs and test results. Has never touched the crucifix.

STARTING KNOWLEDGE I16, I17

GAINED KNOWLEDGE I21 (after 04M2)

LOCATIONS L5 (Zurich), L7 (Day 1 Evening – she accompanies Warhol)

+ / - RESULTS + A Psychoanalyze (Diff 2) or Manipulate (Diff 2) breaks her composure – she cries and tells everything. – If agents threaten her physically, she shuts down and lawyers up. All her information becomes HQ-only.

NPC8 – Andy Warhol

ROLE The Buyer – Artist, Survivor, Frightened Man

ORGANIZATION 04 – The Buyer

DISPOSITION 3 – Polite, detached, vibrating with quiet anxiety

SECRET Warhol is not a villain. He is a man who died on an operating table in 1968 and has spent every day since waiting for the next Valerie Solanas to walk through the door. He wears a surgical corset. He is terrified of hospitals. He cannot be touched without flinching. The crucifix is not an acquisition – it is the only thing that has ever promised him he will not have to be afraid again. He does not want power. He does not want immortality for its own sake. He wants to stop being scared. He would pay everything he has for that. And when the agents confront him, they will see someone who is not a mastermind, not a villain – just a fragile, famous, deeply frightened man who made a terrible decision for a reason anyone could understand.

GOAL Acquire the crucifix. Wear it. Stop being afraid. He has not thought beyond that moment.

ARTIFACT CONNECTION Never touched it. Does not fully understand it. Believes it is a miracle – and for him, that is enough.

STARTING KNOWLEDGE None (case start). I21 (after 04M2)

GAINED KNOWLEDGE I22 (if agents explain the full story to him)

LOCATIONS L7 (Day 1 Evening – in the parking lot, in a Gulfstream at a nearby airstrip)

+ / - RESULTS + Warhol does not fight. He does not run. If agents explain what the crucifix really is – and what it will do to him – he listens. He has been lied to by the Compact. A genuine human conversation (Psychoanalyze Diff 2 or Manipulate Diff 3) can convince him to walk away. – If agents threaten him, he withdraws – not hostile, just retreating into the shell he has lived in since 1968. If anyone uses violence in his presence, he freezes (treat as Panic Table: Freeze). Warhol's safety is the agents' moral responsibility – if he is harmed in their presence, it is a campaign-level failure.